The Discording Tales



A First-Person Immersive-Sim Action RPG where exploration, evolution and experimentation create unforgettable experiences.

Created by
Hugues de Pingon · Théotime Millois · Quentin Huengi · Zeineb Geissbühler · Nolan Zannato · Delphine Martres · Dylan Harbi · Mathias Rufer · Patrice Le

Project Overview

The Discording Tales is more than a game; it is the first expression of an original entertainment IP built for long-term growth.

Over the past five years, our team has developed a rich fantasy universe with its own history, civilizations, cultures and mysteries. Originally conceived as a philosophical fiction before then a tabletop role-playing game, it has naturally evolved into ***The Discording Tales***.

At its heart lies an original fantasy universe designed to expand through multiple games, stories, and complementary creative media, while fostering a passionate community that will help shape its future.
The Discording Tales is only the first chapter of a much larger story.

Project at a glance	
Genre	First-person immersive sim Action RPG
Estimated Playtime	2-3 hours for the demo, 20+ hours for the full game
Target Audience	Core PC and console players, including mid-core and casual players drawn to immersive worlds
Target Players	Mid-core and casual players who enjoy immersive worlds such as The Elder Scrolls III: Morrowind, Gloomwood, and immersive RPGs centred on exploration, player agency, and discovery
Platforms	PC at launch, with console releases considered in the future. Keyboard & mouse and full controller support
Distribution	Steam (initial release)
Age Rating	PEGI 13-16 (target, violence and mature themes)
Pricing	Premium title, with Early Access from approximately $**30**, followed by a full commercial release
Business Model	Grants/Investments/Crowdfunding → Early Access → Full Release → Modding Support → Major Expansions

Our Ambition

To build one of the world's most distinctive immersive fantasy IPs by reinterpreting them through different first principles.

We believe the next generation of RPGs will be defined by systemic gameplay rather than scripted content. *The Discording Tales* combines immersive simulation, player freedom and a rich original universe to create experiences that players genuinely own.

Our ambition goes beyond a single game; we are laying the foundation for a long-term entertainment franchise. At its heart lies an original fantasy universe designed to expand through multiple games, stories, and complementary creative media, while fostering a passionate community that will help shape its future.





The Opportunity

Modern RPGs increasingly guide players through carefully scripted experiences, leaving little room for genuine experimentation, discovery and player-driven storytelling.

- **Predictable experiences → Players feel constrained.**

As production costs rise, many studios prioritize proven formulas and familiar mechanics, resulting in increasingly guided experiences rather than truly emergent worlds.

- **Limited player agency → Players crave meaningful choice.**

Despite increasingly larger and more detailed worlds, many games still funnel players toward predetermined solutions. Players increasingly value experiences where their choices, experimentation, and creativity genuinely shape the world around them.

- **Fewer original universes → New IP is increasingly scarce.**

The industry continues to expand, yet fewer new intellectual properties establish truly distinctive worlds capable of becoming enduring franchises. Players increasingly seek universes with a strong identity and lasting depth.

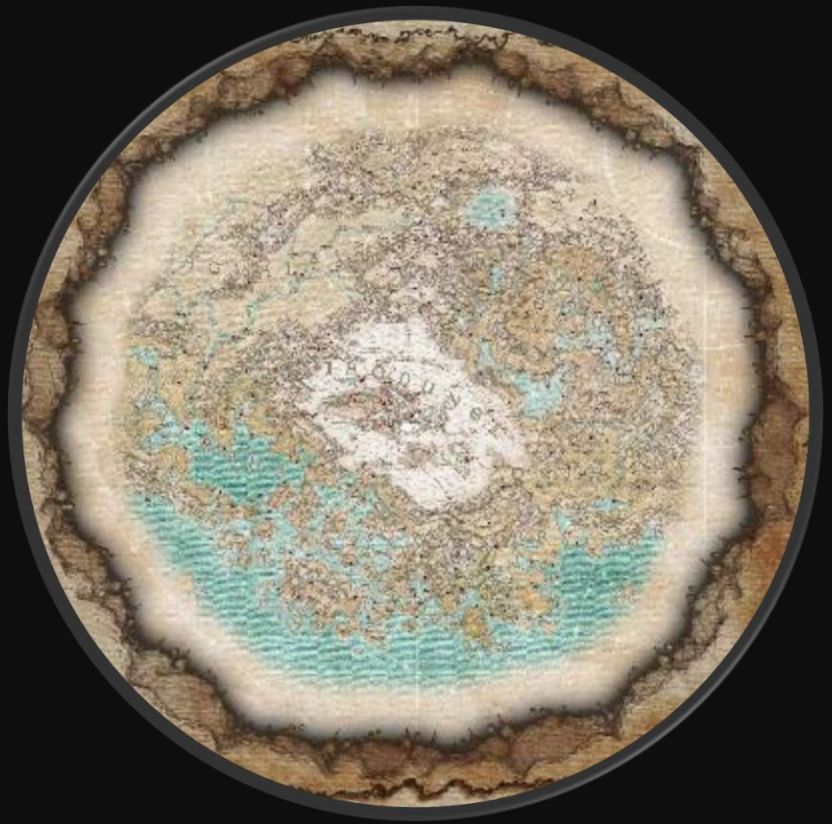
Our Solution

Building worlds that players truly make their own and with high replayability.

Promise	How we deliver it
Freedom	Systemic gameplay creates multiple valid approaches, allowing players to solve challenges according to their own playstyle
Discovery	A handcrafted universe rich in mystery, culture and hidden knowledge, where understanding the world improving oneself continually unlocks new opportunities
Emergence	Physics, and interconnected systems through data-oriented architectures naturally create unexpected situations and memorable gameplay moments
Ownership	Persistent systems and meaningful player choices through the exploration of moral extremes ensure every playthrough tells a unique story shaped by the player
Replayability	New tools, knowledge and abilities transform previously explored areas, encouraging players to revisit the same areas from a new perspective

The result is a next-generation immersive simulation Action RPG where no two playthrough are ever the same.





A Universe Built to Last

- **A Vertical Dive**

Beneath the frozen remains of the ancient Lake Iaôdunaï lies a vast interconnected world of caverns, wandering bands, ancient ruins, colonizing civilizations. Every layer tells a different story, offering its own cultures, ecosystems, and dangers.

- **Ancient Technology & Mystery**

Long-forgotten relics infused with Ril, an ancient techno-magical force at the root of the world's creation, have triggered a race for knowledge and power. Beneath every discovery lies another mystery waiting to reshape the player's perspective of the world.

- **A Living Political Ecosystem**

Factions, cultures, and people pursue their own ambitions through alliances, commerce, conflict, and betrayal. The world continues to evolve whether the player intervenes or not.

- **A Personal Journey with Global Consequences**

Awakening from an experimental stasis with no learned experience of the world, your search for identity gradually reveals a far greater conflict: the suicidal cult of Dærghul, the crystallizing plague and the rush for artefacts triggering all surviving factions against one another.

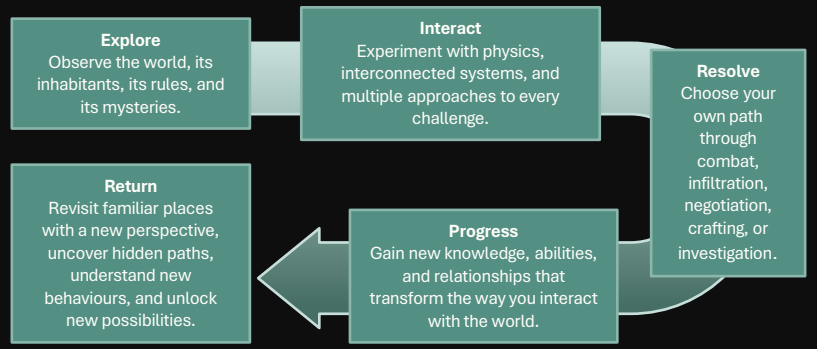
Every descent uncovers another layer of history, mystery, and possibility.



The Player Experience

A world where almost everything is visible, but almost nothing can be mastered without understanding it.

Core Gameplay Loop



What the player experiences :

- Every discovery reveals a new way of understanding the world.
- Obstacles become opportunities as knowledge grows.
- Emergent situations arise naturally.
- The greatest reward is the moment of realization.

Player Agency in Action

Situation

The player discovers a rope leading upward, a side tunnel, and a locked gate guarded by a patrol.

Rather than prescribing a single solution, the world encourages experimentation.

Players may:

- Sneak through hidden passages
- Manipulate light and the environment
- Exploit creature behaviours
- Fight or negotiate
- Use previously acquired knowledge to unlock new opportunities

Every choice creates different consequences.
The player's decisions influence progression, encounters, and future opportunities as its inhabitants react an plan autonomously based on how the world has changed.

A World Worth Revisiting
Returning later with new knowledge, tools, or relationships reveals hidden shortcuts, new interactions, and entirely different ways to experience familiar places.

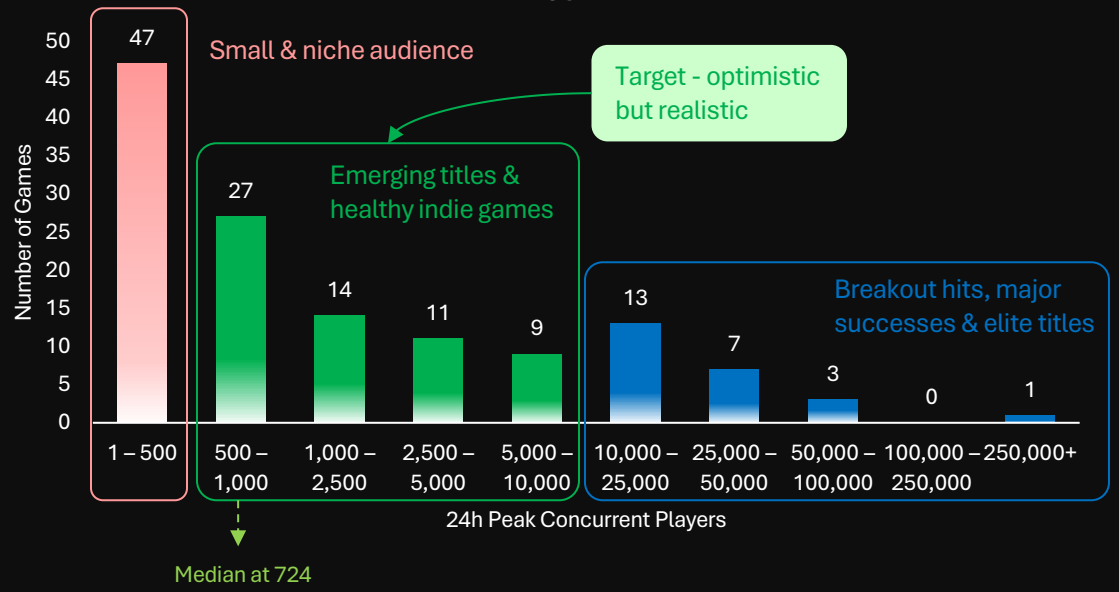
Progress is not only about going further - it is about seeing the world differently.
The greatest reward lies in the moment of realization



Market Opportunity

Our analysis of Steam identified 132 games directly comparable to ***The Discording Tales***. These titles collectively reached more than 1.5 million peak concurrent players over a 24-hour period, demonstrating a large and highly engaged audience on PC alone. This analysis excludes console platforms such as PlayStation and Xbox, suggesting the total addressable audience for this genre is significantly larger.

Distribution of 24h Peak Concurrent Players Across 132 Comparable RPGs



Why We Are Positioned to Win

1 Growing Premium RPG Market
Premium RPGs continue to attract millions of highly engaged players seeking deep, high-quality experiences.

2 Underserved Segment
Despite strong demand, relatively few studios develop systemic immersive RPGs, leaving room for differentiated experiences.

3 Players Reward Original IP
Recent successes demonstrate that players actively embrace new worlds with distinctive identities and memorable experiences.

4 Positioned for Long-Term Value
Designed as an original IP from day one, *The Discording Tales* is built to grow through sequels, expansions, and cross-media storytelling.

Development Strategy

Our development strategy is built around a stage-gated validation framework. Each milestone is designed to answer a critical question and reduce a specific project risk before moving to the next phase.

Alongside development, we will continuously monitor community interest and player feedback through Steam, wishlists, social media, crowdfunding campaigns, public playtests, and other engagement channels to ensure the project evolves in line with player expectations and market demand.



Phase 1
Vision Validation

Phase 2
Gameplay Validation

Phase 3
Player Validation

Phase 4
Production

Phase 5
Launch & Growth

Intent Trailer
Is the creative vision compelling?

Deliverables:
- Art direction
- World identity
- Atmosphere
- Initial visibility

✅ Creative Risk

Vertical Slice
Is the gameplay genuinely fun?

Deliverables:
- Core systems
- Combat
- Exploration
- Simulation

✅ Product Risk

Public Demo
Do players want this game?

Deliverables:
- Early access
- Community-driven iteration
- Real player feedback
- Player retention insights

✅ Market Fit Risk

Full Production
Can we build the complete experience?

Deliverables:
- Full content production
- Hiring
- Scaling

✅ Production Risk

Launch
Can the IP grow sustainably?

Deliverables:
- Release
- Expansions
- Modding Support
- Community
- Franchise

✅ Commercial Risk



Progress So Far

🌍 A Mature Creative Vision

- More than **five years** of worldbuilding and universe development
- Original lore, civilizations, factions, and narrative established
- Strong artistic direction and long-term franchise vision

🎮 Gameplay & Technical Foundations

- Game & World Design Documents completed
- Core gameplay loop designed
- Systemic gameplay philosophy established.
- Key simulation mechanics identified
- Development roadmap and milestone plan defined
- Prototypes of core gameplay features tested (Inversed Kinematic world-interactions, GOAP + Utility NPC AI, etc.)

👥 Team Assembled

- Multidisciplinary team brought together. Creative, technical, artistic, audio, and business expertise
- Project governance and IP framework established
- Initial funding and partnership discussions underway

Investment Strategy

Capital deployed to accelerate development, unlock value, and systematically reduce project risk.

Rather than funding the entire journey upfront, we seek strategic investment that accelerates each development milestone. Every milestone increases the value of the project by validating key assumptions, reducing uncertainty, and preparing the next stage of growth.



Investment Area	Primary Objective
👥 **Team Allocation**	Increase the team's dedicated time allocation to accelerate development.
🎮 **Production**	Accelerate game development.
📣 **Community**	Build and validate player demand.
⚖️ **Operations**	Protect and structure the business.
🤝 **Growth**	Secure partnerships and future funding.

Every investment milestone strengthens confidence in the project while creating measurable value for future partners and investors.

Meet the Team



Creator of *The Discording Tales* Universe & Creative Director

- Over **five years** dedicated to creating the universe of *The Discording Tales*.
- **Lead Game Designer** on **The Wayward Realms**, developed by the original creators of **The Elder Scrolls** series.
- Responsible for the project's **creative vision, game design, narrative, and overall creative direction**.

Creative Portfolio: Hugues de Pingon | Lead Game Designer, Philosopher & System Designer

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Game Designer & Gameplay Programmer	Hugues
Level Designer & Hard Surface 3D Artist	Dylan
Organic 3D Artist & Technical Artist	Zeineb, Théotime, Nolan
Simulation & Physics Engineer	Delphine
Sound Design & Music Composition	Quentin, Mathias
Strategy, Product & Business Development	Patrice

Based in Switzerland

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The Discording Tales is being developed by a multidisciplinary team of independent creators, bringing together emerging talent from Switzerland's video game ecosystem. Their complementary expertise spans every core discipline required to bring an ambitious RPG to life - from creative direction and engineering to art, audio, and business strategy.

United by a shared ambition: to build an original immersive RPG where artistic vision, systemic design, and meaningful player freedom come together to create unforgettable experiences.

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